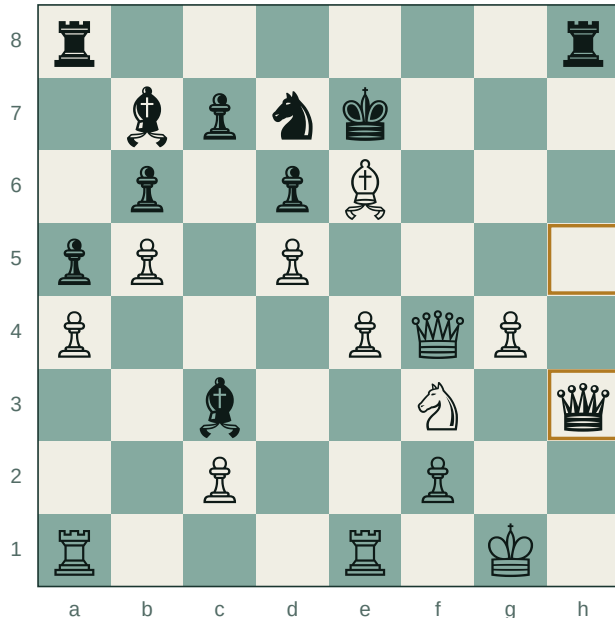


Mate in two: White, move 25

Mate in two

White to move



Previous move: 24...Qxh3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Qf7+ Kd8 26. Qxd7#

25.Qf7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **25...Kd8**.

26.Qxd7# Mate: queen on d7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on d8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on d7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The displayed line is one recorded defense. Test other legal replies instead of assuming the defender must copy it.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A mating combination must survive the defender's reply. The first move should force a position in which a second move ends the game against every defense.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the likely mating square and the defender that prevents it. Calculate the forcing move that removes that resource.

The defending king is on e7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7 and bishop on c3. Check for tactical protection.